Marcus Okafor

Backend Engineer (Python)

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SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 3.5 years of experience building Python APIs on PostgreSQL. Focused on correctness, testing and fast queries; comfortable owning services from design to production.

EXPERIENCE

Backend Engineer — Fieldnote Health, Chicago, IL

Feb 2024 – Present

- Build FastAPI services for appointment scheduling that handle about 1.2 million requests per day.
- Designed idempotent payment-webhook processing with PostgreSQL row locks and a transactional outbox.
- Cut p95 latency of the provider search endpoint from 900 ms to 180 ms with query rewrites and composite indexes.
- Mentor two interns and maintain the team's pytest fixtures and CI pipeline.

Junior Backend Developer — Brightline Commerce, Chicago, IL

Apr 2023 – Jan 2024

- Developed Django REST Framework endpoints for the order management system.
- Moved slow report generation into Celery workers backed by Redis.
- Added integration tests with testcontainers and raised coverage from 48% to 81%.

SKILLS

Languages: Python (asyncio, typing), SQL, Bash
Frameworks: FastAPI, Django, SQLAlchemy, Pydantic, Celery
Data: PostgreSQL, Redis
Tooling: Docker, GitHub Actions, pytest, testcontainers; Kubernetes (basic)

EDUCATION

B.S. Software Engineering, Northfield Polytechnic